Section M: Employee Handbook

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Effective date: Jan. 1, 2027. Review cycle: once a year.

Regulatory basis: K.A.R. 28-51-103(b)(1)(D) (written personnel policies available to all employees); other items are agency policy with no KDHE rule.

M-1. Welcome

Dear Care Team Member:

Welcome to our family! We are thrilled to have you join Golden Rule Home Care. You have chosen a path that requires immense compassion, patience, and heart, and we are honored that you chose to share those gifts with us and the individuals we serve. We want you to know that your hard work, empathy, and dedication are deeply valued, recognized, and appreciated. Thank you for bringing your unique light to our team.[2]

This handbook gives the Care Team day-to-day working guidance for following the policies of Golden Rule Home Care & Concierge Services LLC.[2] The full policy letters come before it in binder Sections A through L. Every employee may read the policy binder at the office.[1] Use those letters when you need the full rule, and ask the administrator when you need help applying it to a shift.

The next pages cover who you are here, how the day runs, how we protect clients, how we look after you, what happens when something goes wrong, and how employment ends.

M-2. Employment Status

Full time means 32 hours a week.[2] Part time means under 32 hours a week.[2] Every new caregiver serves a 90-day probation period.[2]

Employees are paid on a W-2.[2] Caregivers, including auxiliary caregivers, are employees of the agency, not independent contractors, because the agency sets the schedule, the tasks, and the methods of work.[2]

M-3. Scheduling and the Workday

Before the shift

Use the live standalone spreadsheet for your work schedule until a client management system is chosen. The administrator sets the schedule.[2] Check the visit times before heading out. If an assignment or time is unclear, call the administrator at (785) 323-0104 rather than guessing.

If you will be late or absent

Call the administrator at (785) 323-0104 as soon as you know you will be late or cannot work.[2] Say which shift is affected and, if you are late, when you expect to arrive. The administrator needs time to arrange coverage.

- For a predictable absence, give at least 24 hours' notice.[2]
- For planned vacation or an extended absence, give about 2 weeks' notice when possible.[2]
- For an unplanned call-out, aim for 4 to 6 hours' notice. Two hours is the absolute minimum and is not preferred.[2] If a sudden problem leaves less time, call immediately. Do not wait until the shift starts.

During the visit

Read the written assignment before starting care. If you cannot find it, or a task is unclear, call the manager at (785) 323-0104 before doing that task. Use Sections G and I for the task limits and training requirements; do not try an unfamiliar task or piece of equipment on your own.[23]

Keep track of the care you actually give. Before finishing the visit, check that the record shows the visit date, actual time in and out, services provided, and any change or missed service. Follow the assigned documentation instructions in Section J.[23] A note does not replace a phone call about a concern that needs attention during the shift.

If the next caregiver has not arrived and leaving would put the client at risk, call the administrator for direction before leaving. Explain who is with the client and what care is still needed.[23]

For help after office hours, use the same number, (785) 323-0104. If the on-call person cannot be reached, use the backup listed in Appendix H-A. Call 911 first in an emergency.[23] Ask the administrator where to find the current backup contact before you need it. [OPEN: name the Appendix H-A backup contact before final publish.]

M-4. Travel Time and Mileage

For each trip between clients during the same shift, keep the work travel time separate from any personal stop or detour. Record the actual time so it can be counted toward your weekly hours.[7] Client-to-client travel during the shift is paid at your regular hourly wage; home to the first client, the last client to home, and personal errands or detours are not paid.[7]

Keep a mileage record for mid-shift travel between clients and other agency business driving that fits those travel-time rules. Include the date, business trip, and miles so the administrator can identify the travel. Reimbursement uses the current IRS business standard mileage rate, 72.5 cents per mile as of early 2026.[2] Leave commuting miles out of the reimbursement record.[2] If a trip mixes work and personal travel, ask the administrator which portion to submit rather than counting the whole trip.

Before driving for work, tell your auto insurer that you use the vehicle for business and give the administrator the confirmation and insurance proof described in D-11. Keep your own auto insurance in force. The agency confirms that the insurer was told; you pay any premium increase.[2] Send updated proof when the policy renews. If coverage lapses, tell the administrator and do not drive for work until new proof is on file.[23]

M-5. Breaks and Meals

Plan food and short rest breaks around the client's care. When you must stay on site and available to the client, you are on duty and that time is paid.[8] Eat or rest only while you can continue monitoring the client's safety and wellbeing.[8]

Take short paid rest breaks of 5 to 20 minutes about every 4 hours.[8] On a shift longer than 5 hours, a meal period of at least 30 minutes is unpaid only when you are fully relieved of duty.[8] Caregivers are usually the sole provider on site, so meal periods are typically paid.[8] If you cannot take a break safely, call the administrator for help. Do not leave the client unsafe to take a break.[2]

M-6. Workweek, Pay, and Time Off

The workweek runs Sunday through Saturday.[3] Employees are paid bi-weekly, every other Friday, for 26 paychecks a year.[4] Each employee may choose how to receive pay from the methods the agency offers.[5] Pay rates are set by the agency and the administrator and are communicated at hire.[6]

Include required training time when recording your work hours, including assigned training completed at home. Training time is paid.[9] If hours or pay do not look right, bring the dates and times to the administrator so they can be checked.

The agency may pay a year-end bonus at the owner's discretion.[2] The agency does not offer paid time off.[2]

M-7. Client Care and Gifts

When something changes

If the client seems different from the last visit, a service is refused or missed, or there is a medication concern, call the manager at (785) 323-0104 during the shift. Say what you saw, when it happened, and what help is needed. For medication taken too often, not often enough, or at the wrong time, call right away.[23] Do not try to fix a medication problem yourself. If a client or family asks for a task outside your assignment or training, pause and call the manager. Section G holds the full care limits.[23]

If a client raises a complaint, listen and help them reach the administrator at (785) 323-0104. For a complaint about the administrator, use the alternate administrator route in K-4. Do not argue with the client or treat them differently for speaking up.[23]

If you suspect abuse, neglect, or exploitation

Act immediately using F-1. Call 911 if the client is in immediate danger. For suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation involving the agency or its staff, call KDADS at 1-800-842-0078, weekdays 8 a.m. to 5 p.m. For concerns involving someone outside the agency, or after hotline hours, call DCF at 1-800-922-5330, available 24 hours a day.[24]

Do not wait for permission or for the administrator to answer before making the report. After reporting, tell the administrator at (785) 323-0104. Write what you saw or heard, the date and time, and who was present; give that account to the administrator the same day. Use Section F for the definitions and full reporting policy.[24]

When a client offers a gift

Small tokens under about $10, such as a seasonal card, a small bottle of lotion, or a cup of coffee, may be accepted only if they create no obligation or appearance of favoritism.[2] Before accepting, consider both the value and what the client expects in return.

Decline money and loans every time. Decline property unless it is a small token allowed above.[16] If the offer is outside these limits, or you are unsure, thank the client, decline, and report the offer to a supervisor right away.[2] If the client insists, explain that you need to follow the agency's gift limits and refer the question to the supervisor.

M-8. Media and Photography

If a client or family asks you to take a photo or video, check with the administrator before taking or sharing it. Do not take or share unauthorized images of clients or the inside of their homes, on social media or anywhere else.[2] A request to take a picture is not permission to use it for marketing.

Before any marketing use, the agency must have expressed written permission from the client or an authorized representative.[2] Refer requests to the administrator to confirm that permission. Use the Client Media and Photo Release in Section N.[2]

M-9. Client Donations, Thrift Runs, and Resale

If a client asks you to take items for donation, make a thrift run, or sell belongings, refer the request to the administrator. Do not take the items or agree to split sale proceeds, including a 50-50 arrangement. The agency's default at this stage is not to undertake this work.[2]

If the agency later takes it on, the administrator must assign an accountable, trusted manager and use an inventory system that tracks every intake and output.[2] Do not treat a client's request as that assignment. Ask the administrator how to handle it.

M-10. Illness

Before you come to work

If you have symptoms of a contagious illness, call the administrator at (785) 323-0104 before the shift and use the notice steps in M-3. Do not go into a client's home with a contagious illness.[17] Give only the information needed for workplace safety. Medical details are kept confidential.[17]

Stay home with symptoms of a contagious illness, such as flu, COVID-19, or strep, until symptoms are improving overall and you have no fever (100°F / 37.8°C or higher) without fever-reducing medication.[17] For flu or suspected flu, remain home at least 5 days after symptoms begin if still contagious.[17]

If you become ill during a visit

Separate from others, call the administrator right away about coverage, and arrange to go home promptly without leaving the client unsafe.[17] Explain that you are at a client's home and need help ending the visit safely. Do not work through a contagious illness to finish the shift.

Before returning to client care

Ask the administrator whether a doctor's note is needed. The agency may require one after an illness absence. The administrator decides case by case based on the length of the absence, the nature of the illness, and whether you work with vulnerable clients.[2]

M-11. Work Injuries

Report any work injury to the administrator at (785) 323-0104 the same day.[18] Say when and where it happened, what you were doing, and whether the injury affects the care you can safely give. If you need emergency help, call 911 first.[23] If a client is with you, tell the administrator that coverage may be needed.

The agency maintains workers' compensation coverage.[19] Ask the administrator for the claim steps; those steps will be provided when the insurer is selected.[2] [OPEN: workers' compensation insurer and claim steps - select before final publish.]

M-12. Harassment Reporting

If you experience harassment, tell the administrator or a manager. You may also tell Hayley Hynek, alternate administrator.[2] Describe what happened, when, and who was involved so the concern can be reviewed. If internal reporting fails or harassment continues, contact the EEOC at 1-800-669-4000.[2]

The agency prohibits harassment of any kind.[10] Retaliation for reporting is prohibited.[11] If you are treated worse after a report, bring that concern to the administrator, a manager, or the alternate administrator too.

M-13. Conduct and Discipline

The agency uses progressive discipline: a documented verbal warning, a written warning, a final written warning, and termination.[2] The agency may skip steps based on how serious the conduct is.[2]

Some conduct can lead to immediate suspension or termination. That includes abuse, neglect, or exploitation of a client or failure to report it; working outside the supportive care scope; theft or misuse of client money or property; falsifying records; working impaired; an adverse background or registry finding; and breach of client confidentiality.[12]

Other conduct can lead to discipline. That includes illegal activity during or outside work hours; conflict of interest or improper relationships, including accepting bribes, expensive gifts, or personal relationships that impair judgment; attendance and reliability problems, including frequent call-outs or no-shows; misuse of agency resources or client property; counting personal errand time between clients as paid work time; and failure to report incidents.[2]

M-14. No Call, No Show

If you cannot get to a shift, call the administrator at (785) 323-0104 using M-3. Missing the shift without calling is a no call, no show and results in a final warning.[2]

M-15. Investigations

When a client may be at risk, the administrator may remove an employee from client visits while the matter is reviewed.[2] Removal during an investigation is without pay.[13] **[VERIFY: unpaid removal during investigation - open legal question; see note 13.]** Caregivers are paid for all hours already worked.[2]

M-16. Resignation and Termination

Employment with the agency is at will. The employee or the agency may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without notice, unless otherwise restricted by law, contract, or applicable policy.[2]

Tell the administrator when you plan to leave and give your intended last workday. The agency asks for 21 days' notice of resignation.[14] That notice is a request only. It is not a condition of final pay. Final pay is not withheld or changed if the employee does not give 21 days' notice. Caregivers are paid for all hours worked whether or not they give the requested notice.[14]

The administrator decides any involuntary termination.[2] The administrator confirms a termination decision after the facts are reviewed.[2]

M-17. Final Pay

Final pay is issued on the next regular payday after the employee's last day of work, whether the employee quits, is fired, or is laid off.[15]

M-18. Employee Acknowledgment

I received the Golden Rule Home Care & Concierge Services LLC Employee Handbook.[20] I read it and agree to follow it.[20]

Employee name: _____

Employee signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Adoption

The governing body of Golden Rule Home Care & Concierge Services LLC adopts the policies in this section.[21] Taylor Anderson, as sole member and owner of the LLC, approves them and reviews them once a year or sooner when a rule changes.[22]

Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Taylor Anderson, Owner, Golden Rule Home Care & Concierge Services LLC

Effective date: Jan. 1, 2027. Next review date: Jan. 1, 2028.

Client Review

Client redlines: mark any changes on this section, then sign and date below. A digital signature (for example DocuSign) is accepted in place of ink.

Client signature: _____

Printed name: _____

Date: _____

Client signature (digital)

Date signed

Notes

1. K.A.R. 28-51-103(b)(1)(D). Required: The administrator provides written personnel policies and procedures and job descriptions that are made available to all employees. Source: Kansas Register, May 5, 2022.
2. No state or federal rule applies; agency choice.
3. 29 CFR 516.2(a)(7). Required: For federal wage records, a workweek is a fixed and regularly recurring period of seven consecutive workdays. The start day is the agency's choice. Source: 29 CFR 516.2.
4. K.S.A. 44-314(a), (h). Required: Wages are paid at least once a month on regular paydays set in advance, and each pay period ends no more than 15 days before its payday. Any frequency within that is the agency's choice. Source: K.S.A. 44-314.
5. K.S.A. 44-314(b), (c). Required: Wages are paid in cash, by negotiable check, by direct deposit to an account the employee designates or by payroll card. An employer that pays only by direct deposit offers another method as the default for employees who do not designate an account. Source: K.S.A. 44-314.
6. 29 CFR 552.109(a). Required: A third-party employer, such as a home care agency, may not use the companionship services exemption from federal minimum wage and overtime. Pay ranges are the agency's choice above those floors. Source: 29 CFR 552.109.
7. 29 CFR 785.38; U.S. Department of Labor, Travel Time. Required: Travel from one client to another during the workday counts as hours worked. Normal travel from home to the first client and from the last client home does not. The rate is the agency's choice. Source: 29 CFR 785.38; U.S. Department of Labor, Travel Time.

8. 29 CFR 785.18; 29 CFR 785.19. Required: Rest breaks of about 5 to 20 minutes count as paid work time. A meal period, ordinarily 30 minutes or more, need not be paid only if the employee is fully relieved of duty. No Kansas break law was found. Source: 29 CFR 785.18; 29 CFR 785.19.
9. 29 CFR 785.27. Required: Training counts as paid work time unless it is outside regular hours, voluntary, not directly related to the job and involves no productive work. Training the rules require is directly job-related. Source: 29 CFR 785.27.
10. K.S.A. 44-1009(a)(1); K.S.A. 44-1002(b); 42 U.S.C. 2000e(b). Prohibited: Kansas bars discrimination in the terms and conditions of employment based on race, religion, color, sex, disability, national origin or ancestry, for employers with four or more employees. Federal Title VII covers employers with 15 or more employees. Banning harassment of any kind goes further and is agency choice. Source: K.S.A. 44-1009; K.S.A. 44-1002; 42 U.S.C. 2000e.
11. K.S.A. 44-1009(a)(4). Prohibited: An employer may not discharge or otherwise discriminate against a person for opposing practices the act forbids or for filing a complaint, testifying or assisting in a proceeding. The act covers employers with four or more employees. Source: K.S.A. 44-1009; K.S.A. 44-1002.
12. K.S.A. 39-1431(a)(1)(Q); K.A.R. 28-51-103(g)(3); K.S.A. 65-5117(b)(1); K.A.R. 28-51-117(b). Required: The chief administrative officer of a licensed home health agency must report suspected abuse, neglect or financial exploitation, and the agency reports immediately under its policies. No one with a listed offense or adverse registry finding may work for the agency, and workers stay within the written scope of practice. The rest of the list is agency choice. Source: K.S.A. 39-1431; Kansas Register, May 5, 2022; K.S.A. 65-5117.
13. 29 CFR 541.602(a), (b)(5). Allowed: A salaried exempt employee gets full salary for any week with any work. Unpaid disciplinary suspensions of one or more full days are allowed under a written conduct policy that applies to all employees. Whether a removal during an investigation fits that exception is not settled by the rule text. Source: 29 CFR 541.602.
14. K.S.A. 44-315(a). Required: When an employee quits, earned wages are due no later than the next regular payday. The statute sets no exception for an employee who gives less notice. Asking for notice is agency choice. Source: K.S.A. 44-315.
15. K.S.A. 44-315(a). Required: Earned wages are due no later than the next regular payday after an employee quits or is discharged. Source: K.S.A. 44-315.
16. K.S.A. 39-1430. Prohibited: Financial exploitation of an adult includes the improper use or control of the adult's property, income or resources, including through undue influence. Refusing all money and loans, and property other than an allowed small token, is agency choice that goes further. Source: K.S.A. 39-1430.
17. No state or federal rule applies; agency choice. Framing source: K.A.R. 28-51-117(c)(3), infection control, Kansas Register.
18. K.S.A. 44-520(a)(1). Allowed: A workers compensation claim requires notice of injury to the employer within 30 calendar days. Asking for a same-day report is agency choice. Source: K.S.A. 44-520.
19. K.S.A. 44-505(a)(2), (b). Required: The workers compensation act applies unless the employer's total gross annual payroll was $20,000 or less last year and is expected to stay at or below $20,000 this year, not counting wages paid to family members. An exempt employer may elect coverage. Source: K.S.A. 44-505.
20. No state or federal rule applies; agency choice. Framing source: K.A.R. 28-51-103(b)(1)(D), written personnel policies and job descriptions, Kansas Register.
21. K.A.R. 28-51-103(a)(3). Required: The governing body adopts, revises and approves the agency's policies and procedures as needed. Source: Kansas Register, May 5, 2022.
22. K.A.R. 28-51-103(a)(3). Allowed: The governing body revises policies as needed. A yearly review is agency choice. Source: Kansas Register, May 5, 2022.
23. Working guidance drawn from binder D-11 (driver proof and renewal), G-4 and G-6 through G-9 (reporting, written assignments and care limits), H-2 (on-call contact, backup and emergencies), I-3 (competency), J-5 and J-7 (visit notes), and K-4 (grievances). These letters contain the full policies. The shift prompts here help employees use them and do not create a new service, form, reporting deadline or care permission.
24. Binder F-1, How to report. The hotline routes, immediate reporting without prior permission, administrator notification and same-day written account follow that policy. Sources carried in F-1: K.A.R. 28-51-103(g), Kansas Register, May 5, 2022; K.S.A. 39-1431; KDHE Complaint Hotline; Kansas DCF, Report Adult Abuse.